

E.P. Sportsworld Gets Gifts Before The Rush Begins

By MIKE PEMBERTON

Charlie Brown officially ushered in the 1970 Christmas season Saturday night, so we thought we'd get in our stocking's worth before the Christmas ghost descends upon us.

We thought it might be nice to come up with some unusual gifts for some of the top sports personalities in El Paso and around the country. Here goes and may Santa drop all these little bundles of joy on everyone Christmas Eve.

TO LEAD off we thought the gift of the year, as far as El Paso was concerned, would have to be shared by two high school coaches, John Birkhead of Burges and Jerry Wilson of Austin. To them the present from the ghost of the future and past would be that charmed 50 cent piece of Coronado coach Jack Quarles. Maybe he could get change and send each a quarter?

Speaking of Quarles, he should be getting his "onside kick" through the mail any day now. All three of these men take their orders from a man once nominated as a goodwill ambassador. To speed up his nomination approval, we think Dale Waters should get a Snuffy Smith still to aid in the aging and mellowing.

MOVING INTO the world of golf, we feel the golf present of the year goes to Fred Atkins, who was just recently named deputy of the Wild West Golf Assn. (Newly formed at Ascarate after the showdown shootout following the club championship.) To Fred we think Santa should bring a Dudley-Do-Right badge and pop gun.

Following along those lines Joe Alsup only needs some more "red tape" to add to that he got in opening his new clubhouse at Fort Bliss. To Lee Olson goes the present that he need not play any more golf with wife Ona. (His lessons are backfiring on him.) To the Firemen's Golf League at Dos Lagos, their own private lake to throw the players in after every tournament. And to Lee Trevino, a Mickey Mouse watch with an alarm to add to his new clock collection.

Keeping in the swing of things with the people at UTEP go these presents. To coach Wayne Vandenburg, his own private Watts line hooked directly to the world. To Bobby Dobbs, some more "standout" crowds during the season. To Don Haskins, Delta Recreation Center, so the Miners can move from the "Cow Barn." To Andy Cohen goes Dudley Field since the Sun Kings probably won't play there. To Paul Streslen, announcer at the Miner games, who keeps things pretty deep, we give a shovel. To Eddie Mullens, a new simile. And finally to Jim Paul, a new lead for his high school stories.

NOW TO THE racing game, both horses and cars; we'll try to give away a few goodies. To "Cheater" goes a lower handicap for A-Altered roadster. To Bud Hargrove, goes this year's nomination for good press relations. To Ray Sanchez (the horse) we hope he gets girl friend. To Ray Sanchez (the turf writer) goes the name "Dean" in front of his by-line. To Dick Alwan, goes the story of year for his jockey of the week roundups. To Walt Infanti goes a plaque for being the best 19th hole story teller.

Now that we have saddled everyone with a Christmas gift that would do little or no good, we wish to thank each and everyone of them for the help and work during the year. We want to wish those mentioned and those not mentioned a very Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.